

Tournament NLH Cheat Sheet

No-Limit Hold'em · 6–9 handed · raise-or-fold, shove when short

0. Read the format before you sit (this decides everything below)

- **Speed.** Blind levels ≤ 5 min = **hyper-turbo**: you go from deep to short in minutes, so *push/fold is your main mode, not the exception*. Be registered from the start for max big blinds.
- **Payout = your real goal.** Check the prize tab:
 - **Flat / satellite** (1st $\approx$ min-cash; often only a few % paid): the *only* goal is to reach the money. **Far from the bubble $\Rightarrow$ accumulate** — a short stack has ≈ 0 equity for the top few %, and in a freeroll busting is free, so take good aggressive +EV spots to build. **At the bubble $\Rightarrow$ pure survival**: fold everything marginal, let short stacks bust each other, and with a big stack jam into mid stacks that can't call. **Once you cash, your prize is locked $\Rightarrow$ shove every hand.**
 - **Top-heavy** (1st $\gg$ min-cash): chips have real value — play to go deep and win, while still respecting the bubble.

Core rules

1. **Raise or fold.** Open to **2–2.5 bb**; never limp, don't cold-call raises out of position. Not good enough to raise $\Rightarrow$ fold.
2. **Tighter early, wider late.** Your seat decides how many hands you play — a handful up front, a ton on the button. **Antes in play $\Rightarrow$ steal/jam a touch wider** (more dead money to win).
3. **Your stack picks the mode.** **>20 bb** = normal raise/fold. **10–20 bb** = raise small but be ready to jam from late. **<10 bb** = shove or fold.
4. **Don't punt — scale it to the payout.** You never *need* to flip; accumulate in good spots. The **flatter the payout and closer the bubble**, the tighter you fold marginal spots and the harder you let short stacks bust each other.

Opening ranges (raise ≈ 2.2 bb when folded to you; otherwise fold)

Position	Open with	%
Early (UTG/UTG+1)	77+, AQ+, AJs+, KQs	8
Middle (MP/HJ)	above + 55+, ATs+, KJs+, QJs, JTs, AJo, KQo	13
Cutoff	above + 22+, any suited ace (A2s+), suited connectors 54s+, KTo, QJo	25
Button	any pair, any suited ace, any two Broadway, suited connectors/gappers, A2o+, K9o+, Q9o+	45
Small blind (folded to you)	$\approx 40\%$ — raise, or shove if you're ≤ 15 bb	40

When to shove (open all-in) instead of raise

- **>20 bb:** never open-shove — raise small.
- **15–20 bb:** raise small mostly; open-shoving is fine from **CO / BTN / SB**; **3-bet shove** premiums over a raise.
- **10–15 bb:** **open-shove is your main move** when folded to you — tight from early, wide from late.
- **<10 bb:** **shove or fold, period.** Jam any decent hand, very wide from late position; don't blind yourself to death.
- **3-bet shove (12–22 bb):** someone raises and you hold **QQ+** / **AK** (add JJ/AQ vs a late-position raiser) $\Rightarrow$ jam all-in over them.

In one line: Read the payout first — flat/satellite $\rightarrow$ survive to the money, then jam everything; top-heavy $\rightarrow$ play to win. Then by stack: deep (>20 bb) $\rightarrow$ raise-or-fold by position; short (<15 bb) $\rightarrow$ open-jam late; desperate (<10 bb) $\rightarrow$ shove or fold.

This replaces the all-in/fold sheets, which were for a different game. Facing a raise: fold most hands; continue (or 3-bet/jam) only with strong holdings — being the aggressor beats calling off.